

Vermont Parcel Data Modernization

Current-State, Open Questions, Next Steps

Vermont Center for Geographic Information ([VCGI](#))

Hosted for: NEMRC | Tax Dept.

September 16, 2026



VERMONT

AGENCY OF DIGITAL SERVICES

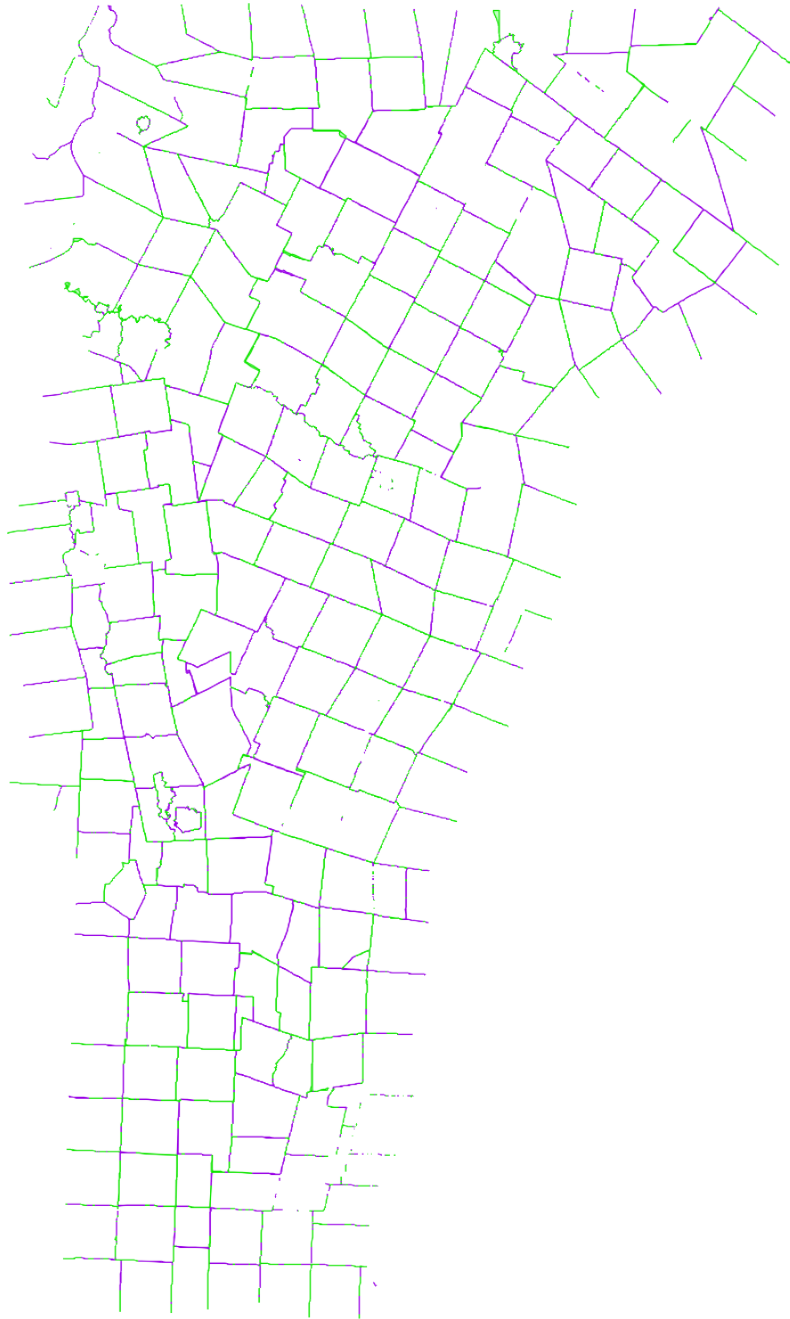


Agenda

- Recap: Why this effort exists and what's changing (~10 min)
- VT Parcel Data Workflow: [As-Built Documentation](#) (~10 min)
- Proposed changes & NEMRC-specific questions/asks (~10 min)
- Discussion (~30 min)

Today's goal: shared and accurate baseline of current practice, required changes, and a short list of things to take away and confirm before the next meeting and/or taking next steps to implement.





Any Guesses?

■ gap at town
boundary
and parcels

■ overlap at town
boundary and
parcels (double or
more counted)



Why?

Context of this effort

- VT has no coordinated, modern survey of its own municipal boundaries
- * **Parcel identity is defined by tax bill & program administration, not by underlying legal land records; not the same yet often conflated**
- ~250 towns, each running its own data maintenance, dB & applications (Grand List module, CAMA systems)

RESULT:



Statewide and cross-town questions of public concern that benefit from knowing how much of what kinds of lands are located where remain hard or even impossible to answer due to a lack of common baseline information.

NEW REQUIREMENTS:



Acts 164 and 170 (2026) require more of parcel data (and their underlying maintenance systems), on a series of deadlines running through 2031

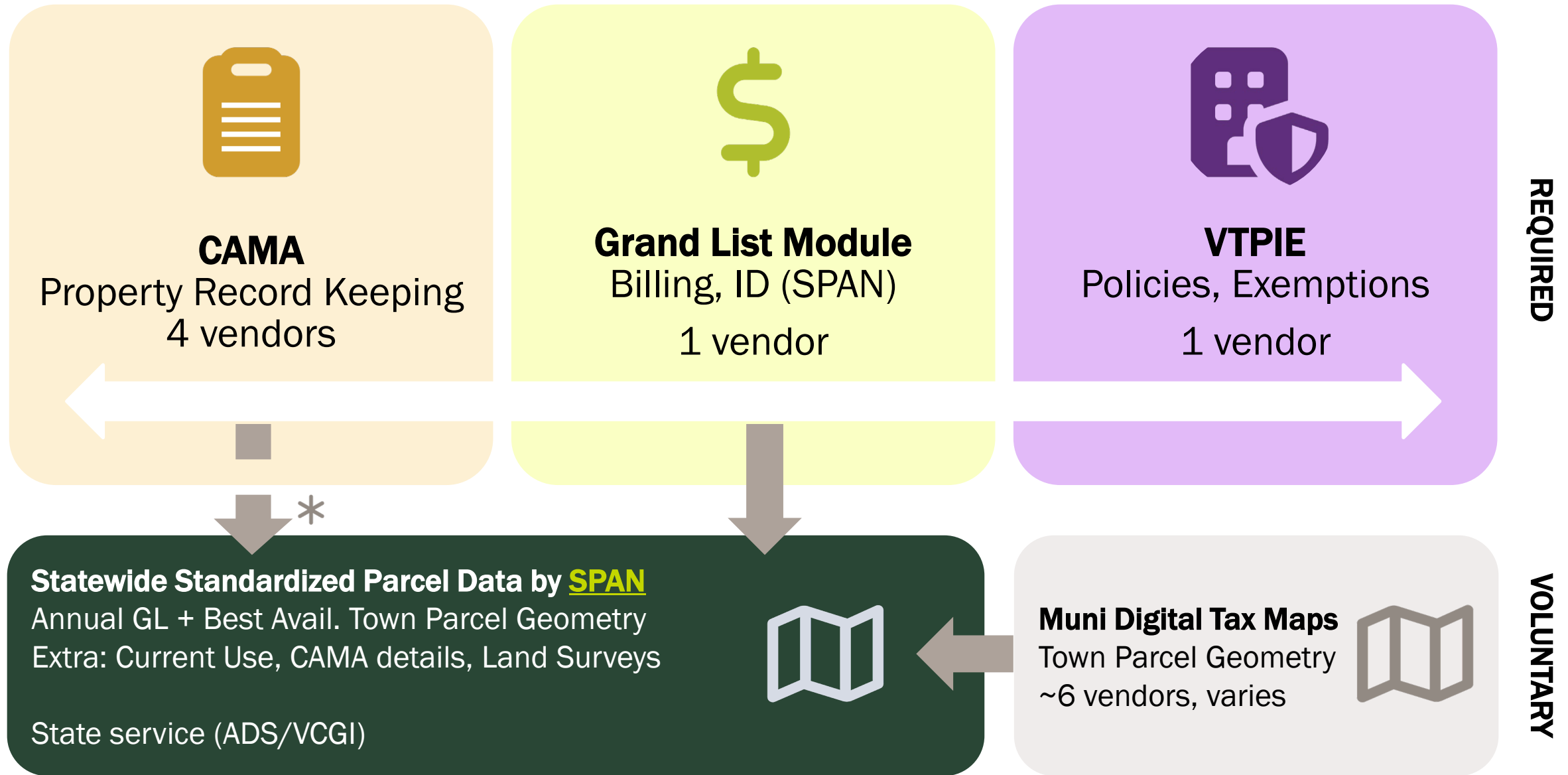


When	Rule	What it does
July 1, 2025 (already effective — compliance still unmet)	32 V.S.A. §5404(b) , as enacted by Act 69 of 2025 (S.127)	Annual CAMA extract to PVR required
July 1, 2026	Act 170, (H.955) of 2026; §3417	PVR Director to establish standards for collection and recordation of parcel data ; CAMA systems requirements
2027 Grand List	Act 170 (H.955) of 2026; 32 V.S.A. §4152(a)(10)	Dwelling unit count requirement
April 1, 2028	Act 164 (H.933) of 2026; 32 V.S.A. §4152(a)(3)	Changes definition of parcel
October 1, 2028	Act 170, Sec. 60	Tax collects property use data toward classification
July 1, 2029 (<i>contingent</i>)	Act 170 Secs. 58–64, 32 V.S.A. §4152a, §5410	Parcels classified three ways (HS /NHR/NHNR) with floor-area proration for mixed use; new dwelling-use attestation
July 1, 2031 (<i>to be corrected from July 1, 2026</i>)	Act 170, Sec. 35, 32 V.S.A. §4041a	Two per-parcel reappraisal payment multipliers established: grand list maintenance and reappraisal year



Existing and Forthcoming Parcel Data-Related Requirements ([Timeline](#))

■ = Existing Statute ■ = Act 170 (2026) ■ = Act 164 (2026)



Three Systems Today and a Unified, Map-Based One Downstream
* *Not yet in compliance or production*



NEMRC's Multiple Roles

- Sole statewide steward of SPAN and the Grand List module — every town, every CAMA vendor
- Also one of four CAMA vendors via MicroSolve (~77% of towns)
- Almost every open question in this effort involves NEMRC in some way
- Why these sessions are NEMRC-specific, before bringing back to others in workgroup and/or other vendors





CAMA

Property Record Keeping
4 vendors



Grand List Module

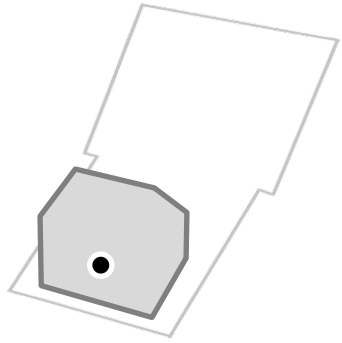
Billing, ID (SPAN)
1 vendor



- **For an *existing* parcel:** identifying data (owner, address, 911 data, tax map, sale/transfer info) flows Grand List → CAMA automatically
 - Valuation data (Real / Homestead / Housesite values) flows CAMA → Grand List automatically
 - Built-in verification exists on both sides (a Grand List report, and a "Check Sync with CAMA" button)
- **For a parcel split or transfer** (i.e., a new parcel record): **no automatic sync** – manual, dual entry by the same lister in both systems
- **Separately:** VTPIE isn't just a passive recipient, it **independently recalculates its own annual Grand List summary**, which towns must reconcile against NEMRC's own figures every August

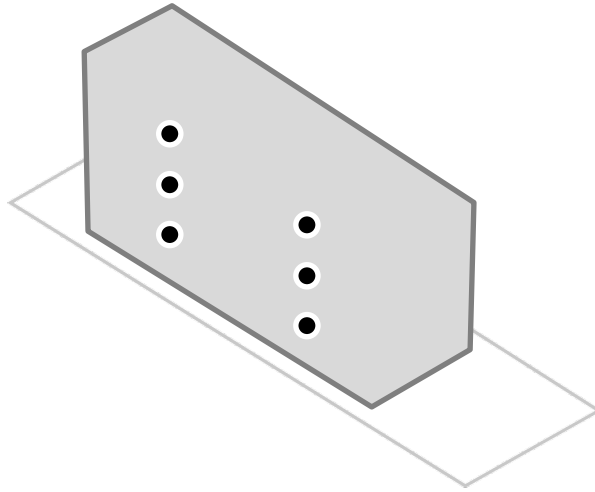


Our Understanding of What Already Syncs Between CAMA and the Grand List
Is this accurate?



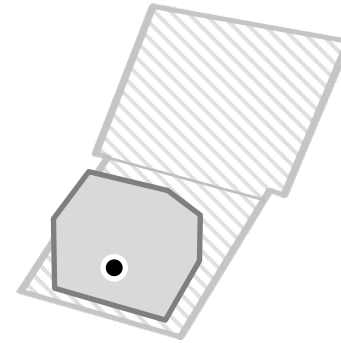
A

1 lot
1 owner
1 tax bill



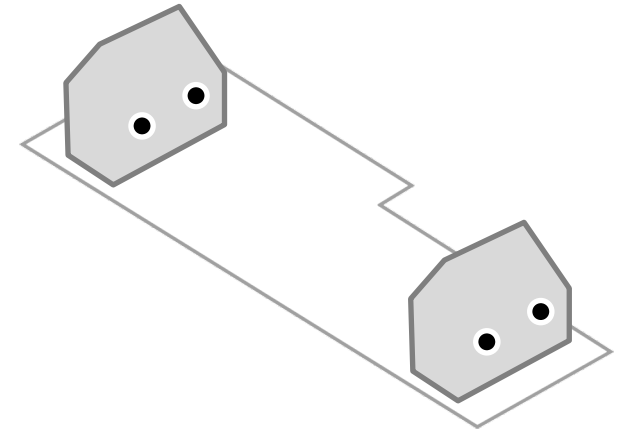
B

1 lot
1 owner
1 tax bill
2 or more units (rental/apt/ADU)



C

2 or more lots
1 owner
1 tax bill



D

1 lot, common
2 or more owners
2 or more tax bills
1 or more units (MHU, condo, timeshares)

Can potentially be considered the same, depending on how unit counts are handled

These two types currently have the most variation in data management and need the most improvement (e.g., “inactives” and “unlandeds”)



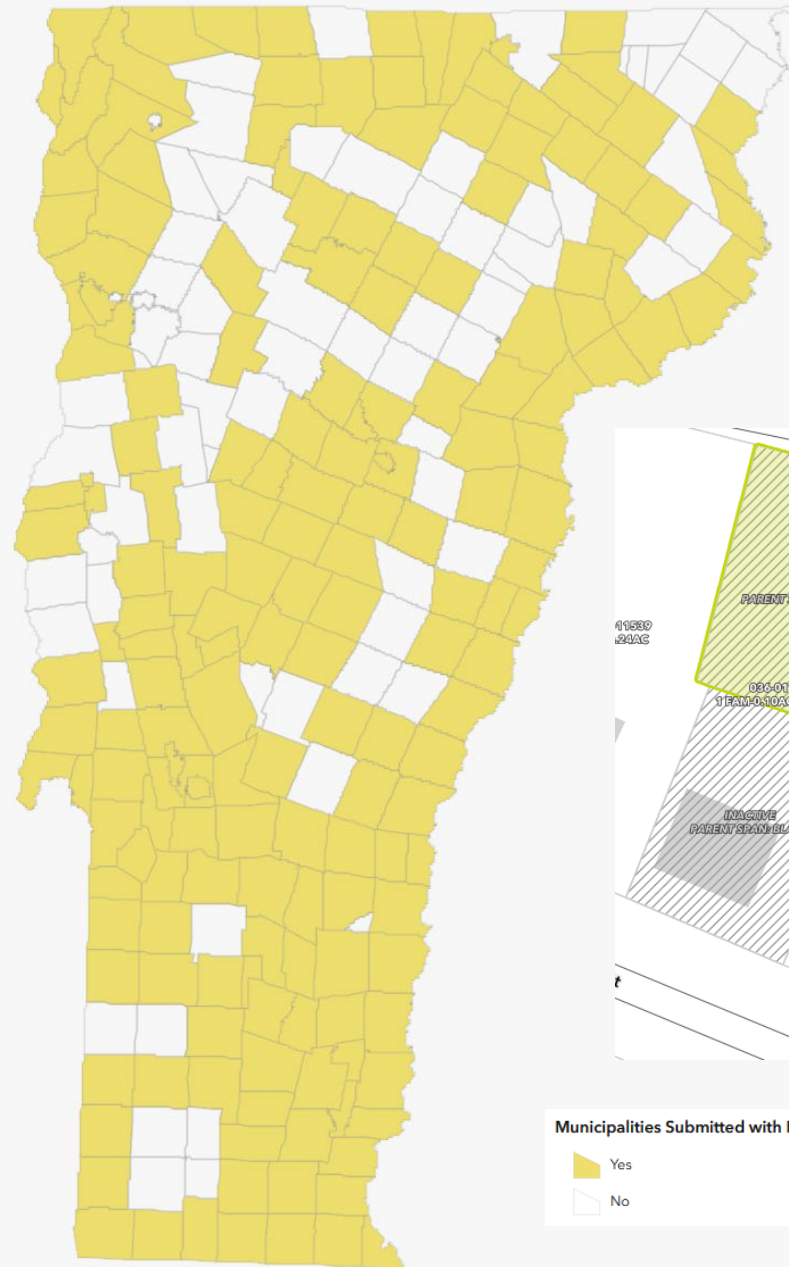
Thinking Spatially About Existing Property Types: The Range Is Not Infinite

~3-4 types; special conditions (railway, ROW's, etc.) can likely also be accommodated within

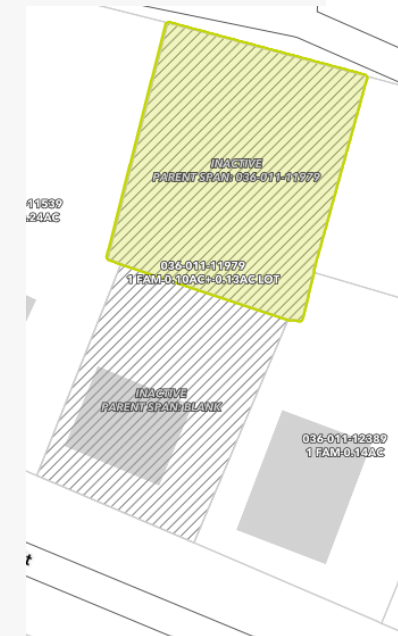
Gap #1

Inactive Parcel Status and Detail Is Largely Not Exported

- The Grand List module's own screen tracks Active/Inactive status on every parcel, in every town
 - But the annual export to the Tax Department only carries that status for TIF district parcels (in ~20 of ~260 towns)
 - For the rest, VCGI's own voluntarily-collected GIS layer is the more complete statewide source of inactive-parcel status (~70% of towns)
- * **Proposal:** expand grand list to track all “active” / “inactive”, likely an export-scope fix, not a new data-tracking requirement



TYPE **C**



SPAN: NOT SPECIFIED

BARRE CITY | Parcel

Inactive Parcel Boundary

This geometry is marked inactive by the municipality.

PARCEL LINEAGE

Status: **INACTIVE**

Parent SPAN: 036-011-11979

Map ID: 1530-VL00.0001

Match Status:

BOUNDARY SOURCE

Type: **Unknown, such as pre-existing parcel GIS data**

Name: **Not Specified**

Date: **Not Specified**

GIS MAINTENANCE

Editor: **UNKNOWN**

Method: **UNKNOWN**

Edit Date: **Not Specified**

METADATA

GIS Year: **2025**

EDIT NOTES

UNKNOWN

Disclaimer: This map is for general reference only. Parcel data are general in nature and do not represent survey-grade boundary information. Substantial inaccuracies in boundary lines or Grand List attributes should be brought to the attention of the appropriate municipal clerk. Vermont municipalities are the ultimate source of information presented here.

Municipalities Submitted with Inactive Parcels

Yes

No

Gap #2

Condos Have No Unit-to-Common-Land Link

- Reviewed MicroSolve's own condominium valuation system directly, cross-checked against a real town's data (S. Burlington)
- Each condo unit's SPAN appears completely independent — nothing links it to the shared ground/common-element parcel
- A grouping concept that exists ("Neighborhood Code") is a valuation-rate lookup key, not a parcel or legal relationship

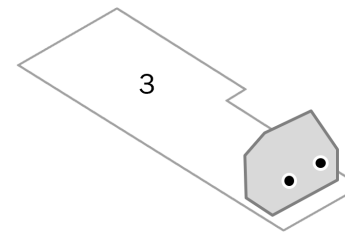
* **Proposal:** a **GROUNDSPAN** field, on both the CAMA side and the GIS/Grand-List side

TYPE

D

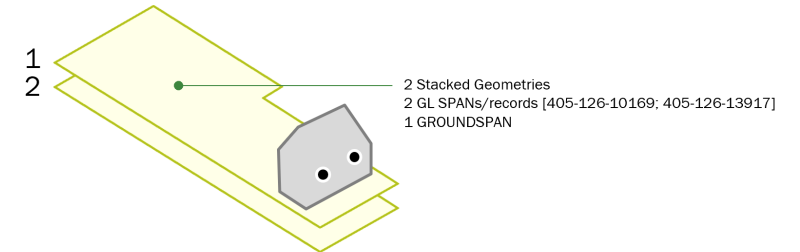
Parcel

Common Ownership (e.g., Condo)



Administrative Parcels

Unlanded Ownership (e.g., Condos)
Index of documented areas in land records,
parcel count to match record maintenance,
used for Tax Billing



	KIND	TYPE	ADMINSPAN	SPAN	GROUNDSPAN	LOCALID	LISTED_AC	PARCLCOUNT	DWELLINGS	OWNER1	TAXBILL
1	ADMINPARCEL	PARTSTACKD	405-126-10169	405-126-10169	405-126-13918	A.1	2.50 (or 0)*	1	1	A	YES
2	ADMINPARCEL	PARTSTACKD	405-126-13917	405-126-13917	405-126-13918	A.2	2.50 (or 0)*	1	1	B	YES
3	PARCEL	COMMON	405-126-13918	405-126-13918	405-126-13918	A	5.00	2	2	C (varies)*	NO

Gap #3

Existence and No Formal Handling Of Cross-Town Parcels

- Situation 1: One physical parcel whose deeded boundary crosses a town line — each town assesses only its own portion, with no link between the two towns' records
 - Situation 2: Two legally separate parcels (one per town) that a lister might consider "contiguous" — whether this is ever combined in practice is unconfirmed
 - Root cause: missing statewide municipal boundary delineation & resolution
- * Ongoing challenge: SPAN is town (and school district) scoped, and stays that way under the proposed model, with additional derivatives

TYPES

A

B

C

D



Fix #1

Create Parcel (includes “inactives”) and Administrative Parcel (contiguous) Distinctions*

- Example: 1 lot, 1 owner, six-unit apartment building
- 2 records (and SPAN fields) for 1 physical lot: the mapping/land record (PARCEL) and the billing record (ADMINPARCL) — only the billing record generates a tax bill
- KIND, TYPE, PARCLCOUNT, DWELLINGS, TAXBILL populated accordingly

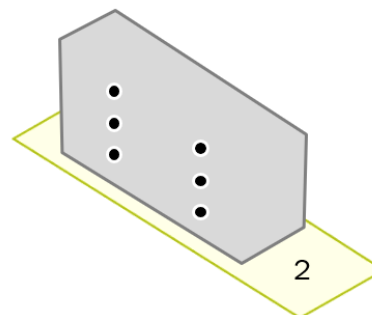
*Act 164 (H.933) of 2026;
[32 V.S.A. §4152\(a\)\(3\)](#)

TYPES



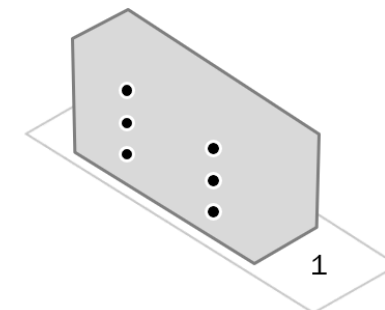
Administrative Parcel

Contiguous Ownership (Apartments)
Used for Tax Billing, Current Use, etc.



Parcel

Formerly “Inactives”
Index of documented areas in land records



	KIND	TYPE	ADMINSPAN	SPAN	LOCALID	LISTED_AC	PARCLCOUNT	DWELLINGS	OWNER1	TAXBILL
1	PARCEL	FULL	036-011-11979	036-011-11979	A	5.00	1	6	A	NO
2	ADMINPARCL	SINGLE	036-011-11979	<null>	A	5.00	1	6	A	YES



New fields

Fix #1

Create Parcel (includes “inactives”) and Administrative Parcel (contiguous) Distinctions*

- Example: >1 lot (currently “inactive”), 1 owner
- 3 records (and SPAN fields) for 2 physical lots: the mapping/land records (PARCEL) and the billing record (ADMINPARCL) — only the billing record generates a tax bill
- **KIND, TYPE, PARCLCOUNT, DWELLINGS, TAXBILL** populated accordingly

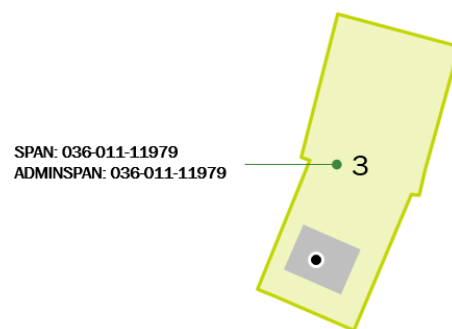
*Act 164 (H.933) of 2026;
[32 V.S.A. §4152\(a\)\(3\)](#)

TYPE

C

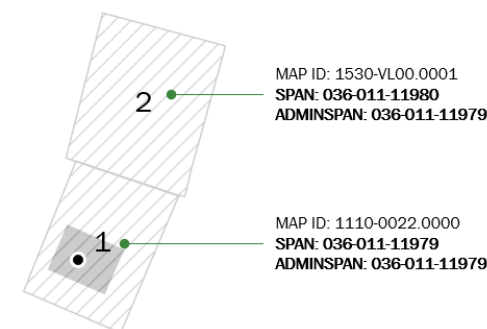
Administrative Parcel

Contiguous Ownership
Used for Tax Billing, Current Use, etc.



Parcel

Formerly “Inactives”
Index of documented areas in land records,
should aid assessment (no conflation)



	KIND	TYPE	ADMINSPAN	SPAN	GROUNDSPAN	LOCALID	LISTED_AC	PARCLCOUNT	DWELLINGS	OWNER1	TAXBILL
1	PARCEL	PARTSURFCE	036-011-11979	036-011-11979	<null>	A	2.00	1	1	A	NO
2	PARCEL	PARTSURFCE	036-011-11979	036-011-11980	<null>	A.2	3.00	1	0	A	NO
3	ADMINPARCL	COMBINED	036-011-11979	<null>	<null>	A	5.00	2	1	A	YES

↑ ↑ ↑
New fields

↑ ↑ ↑

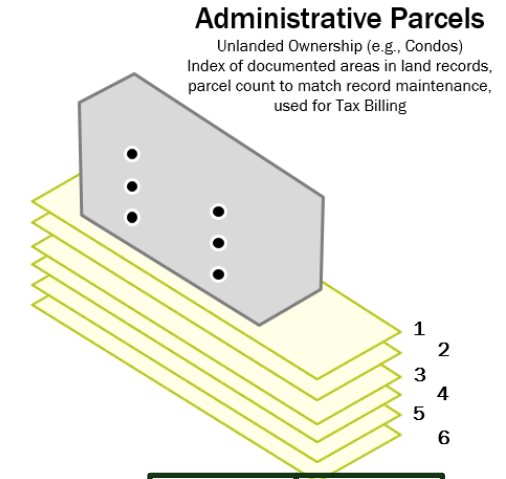
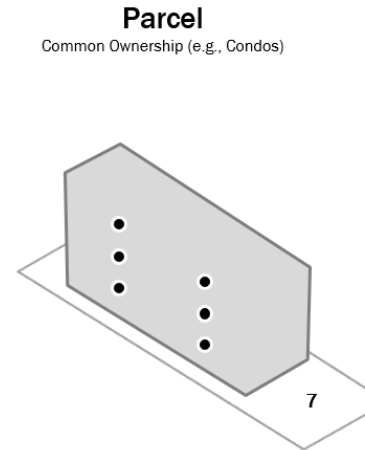
Fix #2

Create Parcel (includes “inactives”) and Administrative Parcel (contiguous) Distinctions*

- Example: 1 lot common, >1 owner, >1 unit
- 1+ owner # records (and SPAN fields) for 1 physical lot: the mapping/land records (PARCEL) and the billing records (ADMINPARCL) — only the billing records generates a tax bill. GROUNDSPAN becomes common link.
- KIND, TYPE, PARCLCOUNT, DWELLINGS, TAXBILL populated accordingly

*Act 164 (H.933) of 2026;
[32 V.S.A. §4152\(a\)\(3\)](#)

TYPE **D**



	KIND	TYPE	ADMINSPAN	SPAN	GROUNDSPAN	LOCALID	LISTED_AC	PARCLCOUNT	DWELLINGS	OWNER1	TAXBILL
1	ADMINPARCL	PARTSTACKD	405-126-13916	405-126-13916	405-126-10169	A.1	0.17 (or 0)*	1	1	A	YES
2	ADMINPARCL	PARTSTACKD	405-126-13917	405-126-13917	405-126-10169	A.2	0.17 (or 0)*	1	1	B	YES
3	ADMINPARCL	PARTSTACKD	405-126-13918	405-126-13918	405-126-10169	A.3	0.17 (or 0)*	1	1	C	YES
4	ADMINPARCL	PARTSTACKD	405-126-13919	405-126-13919	405-126-10169	A.4	0.17 (or 0)*	1	1	D	YES ■ ■ ■
5	ADMINPARCL	PARTSTACKD	405-126-13920	405-126-13920	405-126-10169	A.5	0.17 (or 0)*	1	1	E	YES
6	ADMINPARCL	PARTSTACKD	405-126-13921	405-126-13921	405-126-10169	A.6	0.17 (or 0)*	1	1	F	YES
7	PARCEL	COMMON	405-126-10169	405-126-10169	405-126-10169	A	1	6	6	G* (varies)	NO

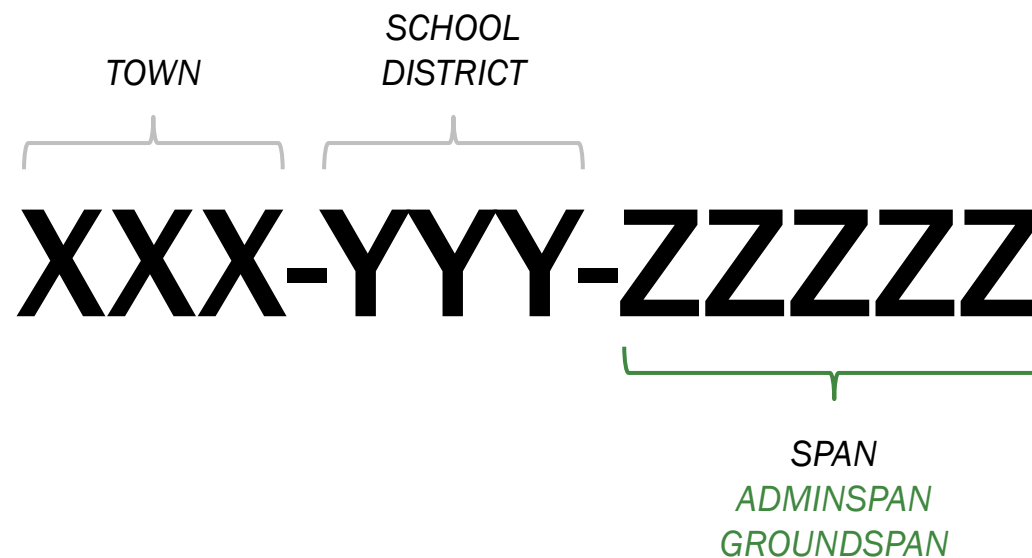
↑ ↑ ↑
New fields

↑ ↑ ↑

~ Fix #3

SPAN as the Statewide Unique Property Identifier

- Ongoing challenge: SPAN is town (and school district) scoped, and stays that way under the proposed model; changing SPAN as unique ID is out-of-scope, **can be used as-is even with new derivatives**
- Fixing town boundaries with modern documentation is out-of-scope for this parcel modernization work





Dwelling Units: Guidance from Tax

- Tax published [its own guidance](#) August 13, 2026
- A dwelling unit needs: its own separate entrance; habitability facilities (sleeping, cooking, sanitary); *and to be fit for year-round habitation* (adequate heating, weatherization, usable year-round plumbing, reasonable year-round access)
- The **habitability determination must be met to count** as a dwelling unit, per the Tax Department
- Independent of zoning/permitting and of Homestead status: a camp can be declared a Homestead without qualifying as a “dwelling unit”
- The guidance also confirms **CAMA, not the Grand List module, is the intended source of this field**, transmitted “as part of the existing CAMA upload”
- **VCGI’s view: changes to GL and CAMA that require dwelling unit tracking should dovetail with other related changes to both**

Dwelling Unit Determination

A dwelling unit can be a building or part of a building, including a single-family home, a unit within a multifamily building, an apartment, a condominium, or other similar property or structure. Answer the following questions to determine if the parcel contains one or more dwelling units that should be on the Grand List.



If there are **multiple units**, answer the following questions **for each unit**.



Is any part of the building designed to be occupied by people, meaning it has space for sleeping, cooking, and sanitary waste disposal?



Does the living space have its own separate entrance?



Is this unit fit for year-round habitation? *How to tell:*



- Does the unit have a year-round heating system?
- Is there running water inside the unit that is usable year round?
- Is there plumbing, septic, or another wastewater system that can operate year round and is sufficient for a unit of this size?
- Is the unit reasonably accessible year round by people and motor vehicles?

If you answered YES to ALL of these questions:



If you answered NO to ANY of these questions:

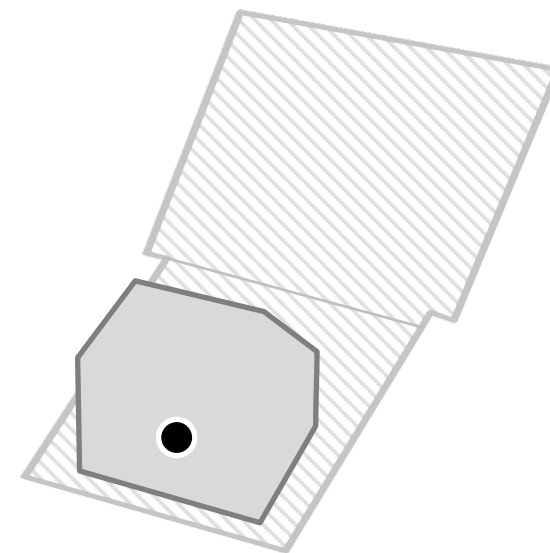
August 2026 | Publication FL-1363





Dwelling Counts: Which “Parcel”?

- The [Tax Department's own guidance](#) defines “parcel” for this purpose as "all contiguous land under the same ownership"
- That's the ***contiguous definition***, not the new "separate, sellable lot" PARCEL that enables additional granularity & reduced need for generalizing
- Assumed: dwelling units are meant to be counted per Administrative Parcel (the billing entity), not the lot or “inactive”-inclusive PARCEL
- **Works cleanly for a simple case, less clear for a combined Administrative Parcel aggregating several underlying sellable lots**
- Act 170's dwelling-unit provision and Act 164's parcel-definition split don't appear to have been explicitly reconciled with each other
- **Timing: rather than change again “in a few years”, cost of doing so vs. coordinated rollout? Means of implementing non-noticeable change?**





Down the Road: 3-Way Classification

- NRES_RES_FLV, NRES_NONRES_FLV, floor-area-percentage splits
- FLR_PCT_HS/FLR_PCT_NR/FLR_PCT_NN: no analog today beyond a binary homestead flag
- Effective July 1, 2029, contingent on further legislative action, sequenced behind the dwelling-unit work, not urgent for today
- Ownership of the underlying policy question (what counts as "nonhomestead residential" vs. "nonhomestead nonresidential" in edge cases) sits with the Tax Department/Legislature, not NEMRC or VCGI
- **Still, what counts as a “parcel” has bearing: which classes are assigned to which record(s)**

Vermont CAMA Sample Viewer

For demo purposes only | NEMRC Microsolve sample data

[← Back to Search Results](#)

Property Details CODDING HOLLOW RD

\$156,700.00
Total Assessed Value (2020)

2 Total Structure(s)

Camp

Water & Sewer

Ownership

Owner: MACLEAN JOHN
Parcel ID: 33130113000
SPAN: 354-109-10606
Status: A

Building Info

Style: 1 Story **CAMP** Year Built: 1940
Living Area: 580 sq ft Bedrooms: 1
Bathrooms: 1 Full / 0 Half Total Rooms: 0
Kitchens: 1

Valuation Breakdown

Assessment Year: 2020
Land: \$121,500.00
Dwelling: \$23,800.00
Outbuildings: \$2,400.00
Site Improvements: \$9,000.00
Total: \$156,700.00

Site

Type: Primary Year Round Residence - Single Family
Description: DWELLING AND LAND
Acres: 31.50
Township: Lincoln (354)
Neighborhood #: 4
Homestead: Non-homestead

Conflicts?

[Building Details](#)

[Land](#)

[Outbuildings](#)

[Valuation History](#)

[Photos](#)



Property Details INGALLS DR

\$2,937,500.00
Total Assessed Value (2024)

8 Total Structure(s)

4 Residential Building(s)

Homestead Declared

Water & Sewer

Current example all on 1 “parcel”!



NEMRC Asks: as a Grand List Steward

1. Can you export a **universal Active/Inactive status field** for all parcels in every town?
2. Can **ADMINSPAN/GROUNDSPAN/KIND/TYPE** be **originated or exposed** by the Grand List module as described here? How to share & sync with all CAMA vendors?
3. Is the **CAMA↔Grand List sync mechanism** described on Slide 8 still current?
4. Does contiguous-parcel combination occur **across town lines in practice?** Handling?
5. The NEMRC Standard Import — a 24-field format that's likely how any CAMA vendor feeds the Grand List — doesn't have a dwelling-count field as-is. **How can this import evolve** to reflect changes and ensure data interoperability?
6. **Establish a change-request process and typical lead time for adding new reporting**

03/28/16
03:49 pm

ANYTOWN Grand List
Standard Import

Page 1 of 2
IT Consultant 2

NEMRC Standard Import:

Required	Fields	Length	Type	Desc
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1*	Parcel id	20	char	There must be a unique Parcel id for each record in you export. All Parcel id's must be the same length of characters. No dashes or dots or seperators, just significant values.
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NEMRC Asks: as a CAMA Vendor

1. **Adopt a canonical dwelling-count field**, or confirm none exists and one needs to be built
 1. Where would a dwelling-count rollup actually be computed — Grand List, CAMA, or both?
2. **Include the schema-metadata/definition tables** (EXP_DATADICT/EXP_CATEG) in every future extract to the State as standard practice
3. **Treat & populate domain-enabled fields uniformly** (e.g., Property Class codes from the Tax Department's [own code list](#))
4. **Review the proposed [Vermont CAMA data standard](#)** and come to future meeting ready to discuss





Recap & Discussion

1. Can the Grand List export carry Active/Inactive status for all parcels in every town?
2. Could ADMINSPAN/GROUNDSPAN/KIND/TYPE as described be originated or exposed as discussed here by the Grand List module?
3. Which "parcel" does the dwelling-unit count belong to — the new sellable-lot PARCEL, or the Administrative Parcel the Tax Department's own guidance describes? (needed ahead of the 2027 deadline)
4. Do cross-town parcels need explicit handling in the new model, and if so, whose call is that?
5. Sequencing: does the 2028 parcel-definition change roll out independently of the 2027 dwelling unit and 2029 classification work, or together?





What's Next

- Schema-level detail (population logic for SPAN/ADMINSPAN/GROUNDSPAN/KIND/TYPE) is in progress. **What would be most helpful? Share & discuss? Other?**
- A separate session with the non-NEMRC CAMA vendors (Aumentum/ProVal, Vision, Catalis/AssessPro) is planned
- All of this is expected to take more than one meeting
- [Full documentation](#) ([as-built findings](#), full [open-questions list](#), draft [CAMA data standard](#), [proposed schema changes](#)) is available to all parties
- **NEMRC get back to us (Tax, VCGI) on thoughts on implementation**

